DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

Comprehensive Project Report

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CSE CORE | First Year

VIT Bhopal University

Student Digital Ambassador

Academic Year 2025–2026

MODULES COVERED

Module 1: Digital Footprint & Online Identity | Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

Module 2: Professional Online Profiles | Task 2 – Platform Profile Creation

Module 3: Digital Assessment | Task 3 – Quiz Creation & Peer Responses

Module 4: Responsible Social Media Use | Task 4 – Checklists & Email Communication

Module 5: Cybercrime Awareness | Task 5 – UPI Fraud Case Study

Table of Contents

1. Module 1 – Digital Footprint & Online Identity (Task 1: Infographic)
2. Module 2 – Professional Online Profiles (Task 2: Platform Profiles)
3. Module 3 – Digital Assessment (Task 3: Quiz & Peer Responses)
4. Module 4 – Responsible Social Media Use (Task 4: Checklists & Email)
5. Module 5 – Cybercrime Awareness (Task 5: UPI Fraud Case Study)
6. Overall Reflection & Learning Outcomes

Module 1 – Digital Footprint & Online Identity

Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

Overview

This task required the creation of a visually engaging infographic that communicates the core concepts of Digital Literacy to a student audience. The deliverable was an HTML-based infographic designed from scratch, covering definitions, key pillars, statistics, and dos and don'ts related to digital literacy.

What is Digital Literacy?

Digital literacy is the ability to use digital technologies effectively, responsibly, and safely. It encompasses a range of competencies that go far beyond simply being able to use a smartphone or browse the internet.

The infographic presented the following definition prominently:

> *"Digital Literacy is the ability to use digital technologies effectively, critically, and responsibly — to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information." — UNESCO / ALA*

Five Pillars of Digital Literacy

The infographic was structured around five core pillars, each representing a distinct competency domain:

Pillar	Description
Digital Access	Equitable participation in digital society; ability to access devices and internet connectivity.
Digital Communication	Effective and ethical use of digital tools for communication, collaboration, and expression.
Digital Security	Protecting personal data, recognising threats, and managing digital privacy.
Critical Evaluation	Ability to assess the credibility and accuracy of online information.
Digital Creation	Using digital tools to produce content, solve problems, and express ideas creatively.

Key Statistics Highlighted

- 63% of students have shared personal information online without realising the risk.
- Only 1 in 3 students can identify a phishing email.
- 87% of employers check candidates' social media profiles before hiring.
- Digital skills are now cited as essential in 9 out of 10 job roles.

Task Deliverable

The infographic was produced as a fully coded HTML file with responsive layout, custom colour palette, and typographic hierarchy. It was structured into sections: header/definition band, five pillars, a do/don't grid, statistics panel, and a closing footer with student identity.

File: infographic.html

Technology: HTML5 + CSS3 (custom properties, flexbox, grid)

Format: Web-rendered infographic, 900px fixed width

Learning Outcomes

- Understood the multi-dimensional nature of digital literacy beyond basic device usage.
- Developed skills in communicating complex information visually.
- Gained awareness of how digital literacy connects to career readiness and civic responsibility.

Module 2 – Professional Online Profiles

Task 2: Platform Profile Creation

Overview

Task 2 required the creation and/or setup of professional profiles across three major platforms used by technology students and professionals: LinkedIn, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow. The aim was to establish a credible, consistent, and professional digital identity that can support academic and career development.

Platform 1: LinkedIn

Profile Name: Aditya Pandey

Headline: MERN Stack Developer | UI/UX + Brand Designer | Helping businesses turn ideas into functional, polished web products

Location: Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, India

Institution: Vellore Institute of Technology Bhopal

Connections: 17 connections established

Profile URL: linkedin.com/in/adityapandey (public profile active)

The LinkedIn profile was set up with a professional banner featuring the 'AP' monogram branding, consistent with the personal brand identity used across platforms. The headline was crafted to clearly communicate technical skillset and value proposition to potential employers and collaborators.

Platform 2: Kaggle

Username: adityapandey0620

Display Name: ADITYA PANDEY 0620

Institution: Student at VIT Bhopal

Location: Sehore, Madhya Pradesh, India

A Kaggle account was created to establish a presence in the data science and machine learning community. The profile settings were configured to display Kaggle Tier, Medals and Ranking publicly. The GitHub profile link was added to the account for cross-platform consistency.

Platform 3: Stack Overflow

Username: ADITYA PANDEY 25BCE11019

User ID: 32558783

Bio: I am a student of Engineering in Computer Science. Always eager to learn something and grow.

Status: Member since today | 1 day consecutive visit streak

A Stack Overflow profile was created to participate in the world's largest developer community. The profile includes a concise professional bio reflecting the student's academic background and growth mindset.

Cross-Platform Consistency Analysis

Platform	Purpose	Key Audience	Status
LinkedIn	Professional networking & job search	Recruiters, employers, alumni	Active – 17 connections
Kaggle	Data science portfolio & competitions	Data science community, ML practitioners	Profile created & configured
Stack Overflow	Technical Q&A & developer community	Developers, engineers, CS students	Profile active – 1 rep point

Reflection on Professional Branding

Creating profiles across multiple platforms reinforced the importance of maintaining a consistent professional identity online. Key lessons included:

- A professional headline must communicate specific skills and value, not just a job title.
- Profile completeness significantly impacts visibility in search results on LinkedIn.
- Cross-referencing profiles (e.g., linking GitHub from Kaggle, LinkedIn from email signature) creates a cohesive professional ecosystem.
- Even a newly created profile requires careful attention to privacy settings and public-facing content.

Module 3 – Digital Assessment

Task 3: Quiz Creation & Peer Responses

Overview

Task 3 involved the creation of a digital literacy quiz using Google Forms and the collection of responses from peers. The quiz was designed to assess basic digital literacy knowledge including definitions, cybersecurity awareness, and responsible online behaviour. The responses were recorded and analysed via Google Sheets.

Quiz Design

Platform: Google Forms

Format: Multiple Choice Quiz (Published)

Total Responses Collected: 4

Date of Collection: 29 March 2026

Sample Questions

Q#	Question	Correct Answer
Q1	What does 'digital literacy' primarily refer to?	Ability to use digital devices and understand online information
Q2	Which of the following is a strong password?	Adi@2026!Secure
Q3	What should you do if you receive an email asking you to click a suspicious link?	Ignore and delete the email

Peer Response Analysis

Four peer responses were collected. The following table summarises the response data extracted from Google Sheets:

Respondent Email	Q1: Digital Literacy	Q2: Strong Password	Q3: Phishing Email
bhavyachourey23@...	Correct	Correct (Adi@2026!Secure)	Correct (Ignore & delete)
sakchamshaw1234@...	Correct	Correct (Adi@2026!Secure)	Correct (Ignore & delete)
ayush2021singh@...	Correct	Incorrect (qwerty)	Incorrect (Click the link)
vishu@gmail.com	Correct	Correct (Adi@2026!Secure)	Incorrect (Click the link)

Additional Assessment: Atexavi Digital Literacy Test

An external digital literacy test was completed on the Atexavi platform to benchmark understanding against a standardised assessment. The result was:

Score: 67% | Status: PASSED

While the result confirms a passing level of digital literacy proficiency, it also highlights specific areas for improvement — particularly in data handling and advanced digital security concepts.

Key Insights from Peer Responses

- All four respondents correctly identified the definition of digital literacy, indicating good baseline awareness.
- 75% correctly identified a strong password, while one respondent chose 'qwerty' — a common weak password, highlighting the need for better password literacy.
- 50% gave the correct response to the phishing email question, confirming that phishing awareness remains a critical gap among college students.
- The findings validate the importance of targeted digital safety education for first-year students.

Module 4 – Responsible Social Media Use

Task 4: Social Media Checklists & Professional Email Communication

Overview

Task 4 covered two related areas: (a) responsible social media behaviour for college students, and (b) professional email communication. Deliverables included two checklists — a Social Media Responsible Use Checklist and an Online Safety & Cybercrime Prevention Checklist — as well as two formal professional emails.

Part A: Social Media Responsible Use Checklist

A detailed checklist was created to guide college students on responsible social media behaviour. The checklist was structured into DO's and DON'Ts to make it practical and actionable.

Social Media DO's

#	Do This	Why It Matters
1	Keep profiles professional — use a clear photo, real name, and consistent bio.	Employers and internship coordinators routinely search candidates online.
2	Think before you post — ask: 'Would I be comfortable if my professor saw this?'	Content posted today can resurface years later and damage reputation.
3	Use privacy settings actively — review who can see posts and tagged photos.	Default settings on most platforms are public, exposing you to risk.
4	Credit sources and creators — tag the original author when sharing content.	Sharing without attribution is plagiarism online.
5	Engage constructively — comment and discuss with respect even in disagreement.	Respectful engagement builds credibility and genuine professional networks.
6	Keep personal and academic accounts separate.	Mixing the two confuses professional audiences.
7	Report harmful or abusive content using platform tools.	You have a responsibility as a digital citizen.

Social Media DON'Ts

#	Avoid This	Why It's Harmful
1	Don't share personal information publicly (phone, address, ID, location).	Can be exploited for identity theft, stalking, or targeted scams.
2	Don't spread unverified information.	Misinformation spreads faster than corrections and damages credibility.
3	Don't engage in or tolerate cyberbullying.	Passive participation (liking/sharing) is still participation.
4	Don't post during academic hours or exams.	Chronic distraction is linked to lower academic performance.

#	Avoid This	Why It's Harmful
5	Don't vent about college, faculty, or classmates publicly.	Screenshots are permanent. Content can reach its subject within minutes.
6	Don't accept connections from strangers without verifying.	Fake profiles are used for data harvesting and phishing attacks.
7	Don't plagiarise or misrepresent yourself on profiles.	Misrepresentation can lead to disqualification, expulsion, or termination.

Quick Reference: Pre-Post Mental Checklist

Before every post, the following five questions must be answered:

- Is this accurate and verified?
- Could this embarrass me professionally?
- Does this reveal private information?
- Am I crediting the original creator?
- Would I say this to someone's face?

If any answer is NO or UNSURE — do not post.

Part B: Online Safety & Cybercrime Prevention Checklist

A second checklist focused on online safety and fraud prevention, with particular emphasis on UPI and digital financial safety relevant to Indian college students.

General Online Safety

- Use strong, unique passwords for each account (avoid name, DOB, or '123456').
- Enable 2-factor authentication (2FA) on email, banking, and social media.
- Never share OTPs, passwords, or PINs — not even with someone claiming to be from your bank.
- Avoid public Wi-Fi for banking or sensitive logins.
- Check URLs carefully before logging in (look for 'https://' and avoid fake lookalike sites).
- Do not click suspicious links from unknown emails, WhatsApp, or SMS.
- Keep apps, phone, and antivirus updated to avoid security vulnerabilities.

UPI & Financial Safety

- Never approve 'Collect Requests' on UPI unless expecting money — approving means sending money.
- Do not scan random QR codes to receive money — scanning always means you are paying.
- Verify payment requests even from known contacts (accounts can be hacked).
- Use official apps only (Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm) — avoid APK downloads.

In Case of Cyber Fraud

- Report immediately at: cybercrime.gov.in
- Call the Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930

Part C: Professional Email Communication

Two formal emails were drafted as part of this task, demonstrating professional written communication skills in academic and industry contexts.

Email 1: Request for Assignment Extension

Field	Details
To	shreecharanmuruganiyer@gmail.com
From	Aditya.25bce11019@vitbhopal.ac.in
Date	Wednesday, 25 March 2026
Subject	Request for Extension – Assignment | Aditya Pandey | Roll No. 25BCE11019

The email was addressed to the Digital Literacy course instructor, Dr. Iyer, requesting a deadline extension due to a medical condition (Jaundice). The email followed formal conventions: clear subject line with roll number, respectful salutation, factual explanation of circumstances, a specific proposed new deadline (28 March 2026), an offer to provide supporting documentation, and a professional closing with full contact details.

This email demonstrates the ability to communicate sensitive personal situations in a professional, non-emotional, and respectful manner — a critical workplace communication skill.

Email 2: Internship Application to Deloitte

Field	Details
To	coordinator@deloitte.com
From	Aditya.25bce11019@vitbhopal.ac.in
Date	Wednesday, 25 March 2026
Subject	Summer Internship Application – Aditya Pandey | CSE CORE | VIT BHOPAL

The internship application email was addressed to the recruitment coordinator at Deloitte, applying for a Summer 2026 internship in AI-Driven Analytics. The email included: a concise self-introduction with academic details, a targeted statement of interest linking Deloitte's work to personal career goals, three specific academic achievements (NGO web application, Google Data Analytics Certificate, GPA of 8.7), reference to attached resume and transcript, and a professional closing with full contact details and LinkedIn/GitHub links.

This email exemplifies how students should tailor professional communications: researching the company, quantifying achievements, and maintaining a confident but respectful tone.

Key Takeaways from Task 4

- Digital communication is a core professional skill that must be developed alongside technical competencies.
- Social media behaviour has direct, measurable consequences for academic and professional reputation.
- Formal email structure — subject line, salutation, body, closing — reflects professionalism and is noticed by recipients.
- Financial digital literacy (UPI safety) is especially urgent for Indian college students who rely heavily on digital payments.

Module 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

Task 5: UPI & Online Payment Fraud — Case Study

Overview

Task 5 required the preparation of a detailed cybercrime awareness case study targeting college students in India. The case study examined UPI (Unified Payments Interface) fraud — a rapidly growing form of digital financial crime that disproportionately affects young, first-time UPI users. The case study was formatted as a professional PDF report.

1. What Is UPI Fraud?

UPI fraud is a form of digital financial crime in which attackers manipulate victims into authorising illegitimate money transfers through India's real-time payment system — including apps such as Google Pay, PhonePe, Paytm, and BHIM.

Unlike traditional bank fraud, UPI fraud exploits social engineering rather than technical hacking. The victim is psychologically tricked into scanning a QR code, sharing a UPI PIN, or approving a 'collect request' that drains their account instantly. Transactions are near-irreversible once completed, making recovery extremely difficult.

> *Stat: According to the Reserve Bank of India's Annual Report (2023), digital payment fraud cases rose by over 70% year-on-year, with college students among the most frequently targeted demographics.*

2. How the Fraud Typically Occurs — Step by Step

Step	Stage	Description
01	Bait is set	Attacker posts a fake listing on OLX, Instagram, or a college WhatsApp group — offering a secondhand laptop, hostel room, or part-time job with suspiciously attractive terms.
02	First contact	Victim messages the seller. Attacker builds trust using fake 'ID proofs', fake transaction screenshots, and an urgent friendly tone ('I'm leaving tomorrow, pay now to confirm').
03	Collect Request trick	Fraudster sends a UPI COLLECT REQUEST and tells the victim: 'Just enter your PIN to receive the advance/refund.' The victim, confused about send vs receive, enters PIN — money leaves account.
04	QR code variant	Attacker sends a QR code claiming it will 'credit money into your account'. Scanning and paying the QR code transfers money OUT, not in.
05	Disappearance	Once transfer completes (within seconds), the attacker blocks the victim on all platforms. Funds move through multiple mule accounts within minutes, making tracing nearly impossible.

3. Who Is Targeted?

First-year college students making independent financial decisions for the first time are the most vulnerable group. Fraudsters specifically target:

- Students buying second-hand textbooks, hostel essentials, or bicycles.
- Students looking for part-time or freelance income.
- Students seeking rental accommodation in a new city.

The combination of UPI familiarity (everyone uses it) with low awareness of collect-request mechanics creates a reliable attack surface. Women students are disproportionately targeted in 'job offer' fraud variants, according to CERT-In advisories (2022–2023).

4. Consequences of UPI Fraud

Impact Type	Description
Financial	Immediate and often total loss of transferred amount. Average loss per college student: Rs. 3,000 – Rs. 25,000 (NCRB Cybercrime Report 2022). Banks rarely reverse without police documentation.
Emotional	Victims report significant shame, anxiety, and reluctance to report — fearing judgment from family. Under-reporting perpetuates the fraud cycle.
Academic	Loss of funds meant for fees, books, or rent can directly disrupt academic continuity, particularly for students from lower-income households.
Legal Risk	Students who unknowingly allow bank accounts to be used as 'mule accounts' face arrest under the IT Act 2000 and IPC Section 420 (cheating).

5. How to Protect Yourself

- NEVER enter your UPI PIN in response to a collect request from a stranger — entering your PIN ALWAYS SENDS money.
- Scanning a QR code and entering an amount ALWAYS DEDUCTS from your account — there is no QR code that credits money to you.
- Verify sellers via video call before any transaction. Genuine sellers will not refuse.
- Use UPI apps' built-in 'Report Fraud' and 'Block' features immediately on suspicious contacts.
- Report cybercrime within 24 hours at cybercrime.gov.in or call the national helpline 1930.

6. References & Sources

- Reserve Bank of India Annual Report 2022–23 (rbi.org.in)
- CERT-In Advisory CIAD-2023-0047 on UPI Fraud
- National Crime Records Bureau Cybercrime Statistics 2022 (ncrb.gov.in)
- Ministry of Home Affairs Cyber Dost Advisory — 'UPI Fraud Awareness' (2023)

Learning Outcomes from Task 5

- Developed the ability to research, analyse, and document a real-world cybercrime pattern.
- Understood the psychological mechanisms (social engineering) behind digital fraud.
- Gained practical knowledge of India's digital payment ecosystem and its vulnerabilities.
- Learned how to present complex security information in an accessible format for a student audience.

Overall Reflection & Learning Outcomes

Portfolio Summary

This Digital Literacy Portfolio represents the completion of five modules covering the foundational and applied dimensions of digital literacy as a 21st-century competency. Across all five tasks, the portfolio demonstrates not only theoretical understanding but also the practical application of digital skills in real academic and professional contexts.

Module	Task	Key Skill Demonstrated	Deliverable
Module 1	Infographic Creation	Visual communication of digital concepts	infographic.html
Module 2	Profile Setup	Professional online identity management	LinkedIn, Kaggle, Stack Overflow
Module 3	Quiz & Assessment	Peer education and digital assessment design	Google Form + Sheets data
Module 4	Checklists + Emails	Responsible digital citizenship + written communication	Two checklists, two professional emails
Module 5	Case Study	Cybercrime research and awareness communication	UPI Fraud case study PDF

Personal Reflection

Completing this portfolio has significantly deepened my understanding of what it means to be digitally literate in 2026. Before this course, I viewed digital literacy primarily as a technical skill — the ability to use tools and platforms. This portfolio has revealed it to be something far more holistic: an ethical, social, and professional competency that shapes how I present myself, how I protect myself, and how I contribute to online communities.

The most impactful learning came from the cybercrime case study (Module 5), which confronted the very real financial vulnerabilities that college students in India face. Understanding the mechanics of UPI fraud — particularly the dangerous misconception around QR codes and collect requests — is knowledge I have already shared with peers and family.

Creating professional profiles (Module 2) was equally formative. The exercise of writing a LinkedIn headline forced me to articulate my value proposition concisely, which is a skill that will serve me in every professional interaction going forward.

Areas for Continued Development

- Deepen knowledge of advanced cybersecurity topics including encryption, VPN usage, and threat modelling.
- Build out Kaggle portfolio with completed notebooks and competition entries.
- Retake the Atexavi digital literacy test to improve from 67% to 80%+ after further study.
- Grow LinkedIn network beyond 17 connections by engaging with alumni and industry professionals.
- Continue practising professional email communication across academic and internship contexts.

Commitment as Student Digital Ambassador

As a Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, I commit to using the knowledge gained through this portfolio to educate and support my peers. Digital literacy is not a solo competency — it becomes a protective and enabling force when shared across a community. I will continue to advocate for responsible, safe, and purposeful use of digital technologies in my campus community and beyond.

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